



Figure 4: Installing Exaile using PackageKit

would be disappointed here. Heck, I even find Mandy's *urbmi* and openSUSE's *zypper* faster.

To end the discussion on package managers, the 11th edition of Fedora also officially supports delta RPMs, thanks to the Presto Yum plug-in, although this is not enabled by default. Install it by executing: `yum install yum-presto`.

You must be aware delta RPMs are a great way to save on your bandwidth traffic. This is because when updates are made available for any package, the package manager only needs to download what has changed in the new release since the last time (aka the diff patch). However, please note, it will only work if the said repository supports delta RPMs.

Coming back to applications, we all know the needs of users vary significantly. However, Fedora, just like other distros, has done a pretty decent job of selecting the defaults. And if you need more, you have the DVD and the online repos.

One thing I'd like to mention here is the decision to include Firefox 3.5. Well, it's still a beta release, but nonetheless, it's working like a charm on my installations. The new version debuts with the private browsing feature—you can access it from *Tools*—>*Start Private Browsing*. The immediate result is, Firefox saves and closes all the currently open tabs, and pulls up a new empty window with the following info: "In a Private Browsing session, Firefox won't keep any browser history, search history, download history, web form history, cookies, or temporary internet files. However, files you download and bookmarks you

make will be kept." In addition, there's more fine-grained control over clearing your browser history—you can choose to delete the history for an hour, two hours, four hours, today's, or everything. Additionally included is Thunderbird 3.0 beta, which finally comes with an outbox :-)

Overall

Although the overall experience with Fedora looks to be quite disappointing, it's also a pleasure running it—where else would you be able to check on the latest features that are awaiting you? Fedora 11 still proves to be among the most innovative GNU/Linux distros. The only thing missing is proper usability checks on essential features/options people come to expect from their desktop OS. Then again, we've too many distros that cater to the usability aspect to make GNU/Linux acceptable as a desktop OS by the next generation of users.

Critics often say Fedora is the test bed for Red Hat Enterprise Linux. I'd like to differ and point out that Fedora is, in fact, the test bed for most, if not all, GNU/Linux distros.



Ratings	
Installer	3/5
Ease of use	3/5
Features	4/5
Stability	4/5
Community	4.5/5
Overall	3.5/5

Resources

- Fedora 11 Feature List: fedoraproject.org/wiki/Releases/11/FeatureList
- Kernel Modesetting: fedoraproject.org/wiki/Features/KernelModesetting
- Nouveau Modesetting: fedoraproject.org/wiki/Features/NouveauModesetting
- Graphical Boot Sequence: fedoraproject.org/wiki/Features/BetterStartup
- RPM Fusion: rpmfusion.org/Configuration

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